UNION UNIFORM

Uniforms were standardized by War Department orders after the first Battle of Bull Run in 1861. The Union government took over responsibility for supplying clothing and equipment from the individual states, harnessing the potential of its factories for mass production. As a result, whereas the Confederacy struggled to kit out its troops with any kind of uniform, the Union soldier was well shod and clothed.

Fatigue blouse
The Union soldier's dark-blue fatigue blouse was made of lightweight wool and featured an inside pocket and four brass buttons on the front. Like all Union army kit it was produced in a range of standard sizes to facilitate mass production.

Short collar

Four evenly spaced US eagle buttons

Domet (cotton warp and wool weft) flannel ensured greater warmth



Forage cap
This was made of wool broadcloth with a rounded, flat top, cotton lining, and visor. The men would sew in their corps badge (in this case "I") and attach brass numbers that specified their regiment (New York 124th) to the top of the cap.

Corps badges either red, white, or blue

Leather chin strap



> "BILLY YANK HAD LITTLE GROUND FOR COMPLAINT AS TO THE QUALITY OF CLOTHING RECEIVED FROM THE QUARTERMASTER."
>
> **JG RANDALL** *THE CIVIL WAR AND RECONSTRUCTION*

Fixing the bayonet to the rifle-musket

